Competition in ecosystems

Ecosystems do not always operate in peace and harmony. The living things in an ecosystem have different needs, which cause them to **compete** in a number of ways. Animals compete for food, water and shelter in order to survive. They also compete amongst members of their own species for mating partners and they fight to protect their offspring.

Even plants compete in order to survive. Plants produce their own food by using sunlight and other ingredients to make sugars. In an area crowded with plants, they must compete with the other plants for sunlight – for example, rainforest plants grow taller and taller so they can rise above the rainforest canopy (roof of leaves) and reach the sunlight. Plants must compete for growing space, water and nutrients in the soil. They also compete to attract insects that help them to reproduce.

☞ **1** Correct the spelling of these phrases by rewriting them in the spaces provided.

a) piece and harmany _____

b) in awder to sirvive _____

c) hellp them to reeproduce _____

2 Circle the two statements that mean the same thing.

a) Plant and animal species must compete in order to survive.

b) Plants and animals live to compete against each other.

c) Different types of plants and animals need to fight for things so that they can live.

3 **a)** List four things that animals compete for.

_____ _____

_____ _____

b) List four things that plants compete for.

_____ _____

_____ _____

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Competition in ecosystems CONT'D

4 Unscramble each of the two sets of mixed-up sentence parts and then rewrite each sentence in the correct order.

a) are Ecosystems + always not peaceful

_____.

b) different ways compete in + things Living

_____.

c) compete Animals + mating partners for

_____.

d) for sunlight + with each other Plants compete

_____.

e) growing space Plants need + and soil from the nutrients

_____.

5 Look at the sentences you have written in Question 4. Write an example that illustrates each fact. The first one has been done for you.

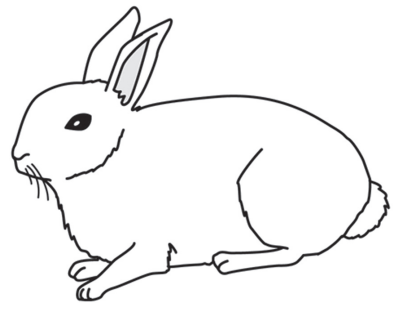
a) For example, rabbits are hunted by foxes in woodland ecosystems.

b) For example, _____.

c) For example, _____.

d) For example, _____.

e) For example, _____.



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